

HOW-TO SKILL • GUIDE

How-to, how-to.

build a polished walkthrough PDF — two ways.

Turn screenshots *or* plain content into a clean, uniform guide PDF: a typeset cover, every image on a shadowed white card with a hairline border, optional numbered step headers, UI patch-outs, and an optional slide counter. One consistent look — two flows.

// 01

Two flows

Pick by whether you have images.

// 02

Flow 1 — assemble

Screenshots → PDF.

// 03

Flow 2 — generate

Content → slides → PDF.

Two flows

pick by whether you already have images.

WHICH FLOW

Images provided (screenshots, exported diagrams) → **Flow 1**: assemble them directly. **No images** (documenting a concept, an API, a checklist — nothing to screenshot) → **Flow 2**: generate styled slides from content, then assemble them.

SETUP

Both flows are Python. Assembling needs **Pillow**; generating (Flow 2) also needs **headless Chrome**. The skill uses *progressive disclosure* — `SKILL.md` is a lean router that points you at `references/flow-images.md` or `references/flow-content.md` for the full steps.

Flow 1 — assemble

screenshots in, polished PDF out.

WHAT YOU GET

Each image centered on a shadowed white card with a 1px border; an optional typeset cover (eyebrow + title + intro); optional numbered **step headers** on result slides; **patch-outs** for logos or controls (solid fill or gradient-safe column copy); an optional footer slide counter.

HOW TO RUN

Write a `guide.json` listing your images (with optional per-slide `crop` / `patches` / `header`) and run `build_guide_pdf.py --config guide.json` . For a plain folder, quick mode: `--images ./shots --output Guide.pdf` . Full detail in `references/flow-images.md` .

Flow 2 — generate

no screenshots? render them from content.

WHAT IT DOES

Turns a content config into styled HTML slides → PNGs via headless Chrome, in the **design aesthetic** (warm paper, one rust accent, serif display + mono labels, hairline rules, corner ticks). Then hands those PNGs to Flow 1's assembler — so you still get the same cover, cards, and framing.

HOW TO RUN

Write a `slides.json` (a cover + one entry per topic) and run `render_slides.py --config slides.json`; assemble the PNGs with `build_guide_pdf.py` using `"footer": false` (the generated slides carry their own footer). Full detail in `references/flow-content.md`. (This guide was built with Flow 2.)